

Lab 04 - Layers, Groups and Alignment

Course: Adobe Illustrator Fundamentals for Beginners (C037) Version: v1 | 4 October 2026

Scenario

Prepare an inherited artwork file for team handoff and rapid variant production.

Objective

Reorganise a complex document so stacking, grouping and alignment are clear and auditable.

Supplied Illustrator/vector files

- alignDistribute.ai
- groups.ai
- layers.ai

Detailed procedure

1. Open layers.ai and save Lab04-Layer-Handoff.ai.
2. Audit the current hierarchy and rename layers or groups by function.
3. Move objects into logical groups without changing the visible result.
4. Use align and distribute controls to correct one inconsistent component group.
5. Create two visibility variants using the same structured master.
6. Ask a peer to locate and edit a named component, then record any navigation issue and revise the structure.

Evidence to retain

Structured AI master, two variants and a brief peer-navigation record.

Acceptance criteria

- [] No generic or ambiguous layer names remain.
- [] Stacking order matches the intended design.
- [] Alignment is visibly consistent.
- [] A peer can locate the requested component quickly.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers or Appearance panel prove that your technique remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?